

Workshop Concept Note

Strengthening the Capacity of Eritrea to Engage with the GCF and Access Climate Finance

Date: 15th - 18th September

Location: [TBA], Asmara, Eritrea

1. Context

Eritrea is highly vulnerable to climate change, including increasing temperatures, variable rainfall patterns, land degradation, and more frequent and severe droughts. These impacts are felt across nearly all communities and sectors within Eritrea, with the agricultural sector being one of the most vulnerable. To combat climate change, mitigation and adaptation strategies are central to the country's sustainable development agenda and policies. However, Eritrea requires financing to support urgent adaptation and mitigation actions.

To support Eritrea's climate financing needs, the country has accessed Green Climate Fund (GCF) readiness resources, through the Sahara and Sahel Observatory (OSS), to strengthen its National Designated Authority's (NDA), the Ministry of Land, Water and Environment, institutional engagement and technical and operational capacities to access funding from the GCF. To support these efforts, ClimFin SRL was contracted to enhance the institutional framework and technical capacities of the Ministry of Land, Water and Environment (MoLWE) to effectively plan for, access, manage, and deploy climate financing through the GCF.

During the implementation of this consultancy, an in-person workshop will be carried out to provide strategic guidance and training on climate change, climate finance mechanisms, GCF policies and requirements, and project formulation. The workshop will serve as a space to empower the NDA with the necessary knowledge, information and tools for the effective mobilization of resources for the implementation of Eritrea's climate agenda.

2. Workshop objectives

The overall objective of the workshop is to empower the NDA and other national stakeholders involved in mobilizing resources for climate action with the knowledge, information, and tools to engage with GCF and increase access to climate finance, ensuring the implementation of Eritrea's climate action agenda.

The key objectives of this workshop are to:

- Build the NDA's foundational knowledge of climate change science and impacts, climate finance, and the GCF;
- Strengthen the NDA's and other stakeholders' technical skills in developing high quality and GCF-aligned project portfolios; and
- Enhance the NDAs understanding of the GCF's mandate, key funding policies including the investment criteria, fiduciary principles, environmental and social safeguards, and gender policy.

3. Methodology

The workshop will be led by the ClimFin consulting team of Keith Bettinger and Rocio Vizuite Fernandez. The workshop will take place in person, in Asmara at a to-be-determined venue, with the option for virtual participation of stakeholders, to ensure an inclusive approach regardless of the location of stakeholders.

The workshop methodology is based on a participatory approach, working with stakeholders and encouraging active participation to ensure clarity throughout the sessions and topics discussed. Presentations, question and answer sessions, group work, and plenary discussions will all be utilized as effective engagement techniques, among others.

4. Workshop Agenda

Day 1: Foundations of Climate Change Science and Climate Finance

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the science and impacts of climate change in the context of developing and appraising concepts and proposals for Green Climate Fund financing
- Introduce key concepts of resource mobilization for climate change through climate finance and global funds

Time	Session	Lead
9:30 - 10:00	Welcome remarks and Introductions, Pre-training participant survey Introducing OSS's role in supporting Eritrea's climate finance readiness and overview of regional experience	Ministry of Land, Water and Environment OSS
10:00 - 11:00	Content Session 1: Climate change science and impacts • Introduction to the science of climate change • Overview of impacts of climate change • Identifying appropriate sources of climate data and information for project development • Understanding "climate rationale" and evidence-based project	ClimFin

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11:00 - 11:15	Break	
11:15 - 12:30	Interactive Session: Interactive Session: Building an NDA Toolkit Part 1: Climate Rationale	ClimFin
12:30 - 13:30	Lunch	
13:30 - 15:00	Content Session 2: Introduction to Climate Finance • Definition and scope of climate finance • Understanding the global and regional landscapes of climate finance • Distinguishing between adaptation and mitigation finance and public and private sector finance and their expectations and requirements • Introducing the concept of “blended finance” and how it works • Overview of potential sources and financing instruments • OSS’s regional perspective and examples of GCF-funded projects in similar contexts (APICA)	ClimFin/OSS
15:00 - 16:00	Group exercise: Identifying potential sources of funding for different types of hypothetical projects	ClimFin

Day 2: Introduction to the Green Climate Fund

Learning Objectives:

- Clarify GCF’s role in the climate finance landscape and operations
- Understand GCF’s mandate, structure, access modalities

- Understand the role of the NDA in the GCF ecosystem

Time	Session	Lead
9:30 - 10:00	Short recap of Day 1	ClimFin/OSS
10:00 - 11:00	Content Session 3: Introduction to GCF • Overview of GCF Mandate and Priorities • Introduction to GCF structure • Introduction to key funding windows and access modalities	GCF
11:00 - 11:30	Q&A: During this session GCF personnel will answer participants' questions about how the GCF is organized, its investment framework, its functioning, and other foundational aspects	GCF
11:30 - 11:45	Break	
11:45 - 12:30	Group discussion/activity: GCF Project Case Studies Exploring Climate Impacts and Vulnerabilities Sharing OSS's lessons learned from NDA strengthening in other countries	Group work/OSS/GCF
12:30 - 13:30	Lunch	
13:30 - 14:30	Content Session 4: Introduction to GCF NDAs • Required Capacities of the NDA • Role of GCF NDAs ○ Strategic Partnership with GCF ○ Country Programming ○ Role in GCF project cycle ○ Engagement with Stakeholders • Case studies of NDA operations	GCF
14:30 - 15:00	Q&A	

15:00 - 16:00	Group discussion: How to apply GCF NDA mandate in Eritrea (With examples from other countries)	ClimFin
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Day 3: GCF Project Development

Learning Objectives:

- Understand the GCF project cycle and structure of concept notes and funding proposals
- Understand key policies in project development such as the Investment Criteria and Integrated Results Management Framework (IRMF)
- Explore key concepts like theory of change and logical framework

Time	Session	Lead
9:30 - 10:00	Short recap of Day 2	ClimFin/OSS
10:00 - 11:00	Content Session 5: Introduction to the GCF proposal development process • Project development cycle • Overview of the structure of concept notes and funding proposals • Project Preparation Facility	ClimFin
11:00 - 11:15	Break	
11:15 - 12:30	Content Session 6: Key Policies and Frameworks including the Investment Criteria and IRMF	ClimFin
12:30 - 13:30	Lunch	
13:30 - 14:30	Content Session 7: Key ingredients in successful GCF project development concepts in GCF project development • Theory of Change, Logical Framework, Paradigm Shift Potential, Needs of the Recipient, Sustainable Development Potential, Country Ownership	GCF/ClimFin
14:30 - 16:00	Interactive session: Applying the GCF	ClimFin/GCF

	Investment Criteria	
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Day 4: Consultations

The objective of this day is for ClimFin to gain a deeper understanding of the local context—including key processes, actors, institutional strengths and weaknesses—as well as the specific needs of the NDA, in order to tailor the consultancy accordingly and to validate the findings developed to date.

Time	Session
9:30 - 10:00	Deliverable Explanation and progress up to date
10:00 - 11:00	Stakeholder engagement : current practices, strengths and weaknesses and presentation of proposed practice.
11:00 - 11:15	Break
11:15 - 12:30	Assessment of potential national entities for accreditation as Direct Access Entities (DAEs) within the country OSS to share recommendations for potential DAEs based on OSS Readiness experience
12:30 - 13:30	Lunch
13:30 - 14:15	Exploration of current Adaptation Fund NOL structure, strengths and weaknesses, could this be replicated for the GCF?
14:15 - 14:45	Strengthening the Institutional Framework for the National Designated Authority (NDA)
14:45 - 15:30	Wrap up session with summary of needs, direction and recap of the workshop
15:30 - 16:00	Post- Survey training and Q&A time